Woods Whisper, She Hunts, Don't Think

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/45410278.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warnings:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings, Graphic Depictions Of Violence

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Glimmer (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Lonnie (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Major Character Injury, Suicidal Ideation, Post-mortal injury but still, race against the clock, Weird Whispering Woods headcanons, Weird Runestone headcanons, Narrative fun with tenses, Alternate Universe - Canon Divergence, Lonnie lives by virtue of Catra's issues being too knotted for the Woods to digest, No editors we die with courage, Feral Behavior, Hurt No Comfort, Angst

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Part 4 of Witch's Apprentice AU

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by genVicron

Summary

Most who lose their way in the Whispering Woods fight to escape.

Catra fought to sink further.

A name always brought her back.

Notes

I don't know if the graphic depictions of violence tag actually *works* here, cause it's really fragmented and dreamlike, but I'm still using it just to be safe.

I think I might have to stop using this style for these, cause Glimmer isn't anywhere near as traumatized/deranged as any of the other characters I've used and as a result her perspective fought me like a rodeo bull the whole way. The "plot" has also left behind the places where I can really get away with using a complete outsider secondary perspective like I did for the first two.

See the end of the work for more notes

Glimmer didn't think ignoring her mom had ever been more worth it.

"Hurry!" Bow called from somewhere behind her, she closed her eyes for a moment, focusing on the dead weight- too light, Moons, she was so *thin*- across her back as she took hold of the moonlight.

Diesel. The smell thick in the air. Smog. Looking for her nest, Woods Whisper. Metal. Hunters, already too close.

"Adora," calls the Sword, Her name, only one that says Her name. Only one allowed to.

Can't let them find it.

She held it as long as she could, she had to trust Bow would catch up. Something warm and wet ran down Glimmer's back once the light pulled away.

There was so much, way too much. The girl wasn't going to last much longer without real help.

First goes easy, goes quiet. Claws catch, tear. He drowns red.

More close. Don't hear, don't see.

Not hunters, Woods Whisper. Only thieves, only prey now.

"Bow," Glimmer shouted over her shoulder, hoping the Woods hadn't turned them around. They didn't have *time* for it.

"Coming," he called back. His voice came from the right direction; good, they were still on track.

Hunt, Woods Whisper. Her claws hide, fangs itch.

She climbs, she watches. Dark metal prey. Ignore red, red makes her **think.**

Next shouts, still easy, still quick.

A bolt of crackling green flashed by Glimmer's head. "Go!" Bow shouted again, pushing at her arm.

The girl across her back made a low noise, caught somewhere between a groan and a sob. She’s hot like a fever despite how much blood she’s lost, but even her shivers were coming sluggish and weak. Glimmer's heart clenched and she reached for the magic again.

"Cmm ba…" And they vanished in light.

Flash of red. Flash of red and snap of power. ***Hate.***

Attack! Her territory, her nest, Witch can't have it! Roar and clash and tear!

Miss, she misses, prey moves, prey **knows her.**

They broke the treeline in a rush and Glimmer stumbled as she felt the tide flow out all at once. She grit her teeth and forced herself to keep running; that might have been the longest jump she's ever managed.

She risked a glance behind, Bow looked a little queasy, but she couldn't tell if it was because of the teleport or the fact that the girl's breathing had gone so shallow that Glimmer could barely hear it.

Can't catch her, she can't catch her. Prey keeps **chattering.** Familiar- no, can't be, can't think, don't think.

Prey favours left side- wrong, wrong, she's right handed- snap left, lunge right. Claws catch, stick. Armour, carapace, metal won't let go.

"Look at me!" Prey's metal face comes off. Snarl, spit, **bite,** Woods Whisper. She looks, freezes.

"Help, we need help!" Glimmer called, still running towards the town. People stopped and looked up, too many faces lighting up with recognition for Glimmer to deny who she's carrying anymore.

She ran into Thaymore with the Ghost of the Woods dying across her back.

Knows face- can't know, stop it, **stop it!** *"Cat', what's wrong!? Where's Ado-"* Said Her name, prey said Her name.

"Shit, Catra," prey breathes, staring- don't look, stop looking, she can't, she **can't**- brown eyes, bright eyes. "It really is you." She flinches, squirms, forces claws loose. Names hurt. Woods don't like names. But… she knows prey's name, too.

"L-" words wrong, Woods Whisper. Head pounds, too much, they see her, they **see.**

"Adora," calls the Sword.

"Lonnie?"

The next few hours passed by in a blur, it took almost five minutes to find someone who could actually help, and by then the Ghost had gone even paler, her breathing barely more than a slow twitch that sometimes went close to a minute without happening at all.

Mom was going to panic when she showed up with another girl's blood all down her shoulders and back. She was going to have to throw out this cape.

"Hey," Bow's voice made her jump and he gave her a gentle pat on the shoulder. "We should sit down somewhere." Glimmer gave the closed tent a long look.

"Yeah."

"Wait, stop-" Lonnie shouts, Catra turns, bright metal talon sinks in, just below ribs. She roars, lashes out, prey fights back, prey always fights back. Claws tear metal, catch meat this time. Prey doesn't survive this time.

Hurts, it hurts, metal slips out. Hit something important, Woods Whisper. She's going to die.

Whispers leave.

Glimmer found somewhere she could watch the tent. Every now and again someone would rush out for more water, but the local seamstress had offered all the thread and fabric they could need at the start, and with the town still recovering from the Horde's attack that was all they had left to work with.

She shared a grimace with Bow, they both knew enough to know that whatever good the doctor here could do, it would only be a stopgap at best. They needed to get the Ghost back to Bright Moon.

Mom was going to be *furious.*

She's dying. What's left of her clothes itch where they don't fit right anymore, the red on her hands is going cold, tacky and uncomfortable, the blood spilling from her gut is too hot. She smells *awful.* It hits her all at once, no Whispers to muffle it, no wild, Hunting thing that won't care to fall back into.

She starts to shake. Lonnie's saying something, it doesn't matter. The Woods left her, she's not going to make it, they don't want a corpse.

"Adora," calls the Sword. She can still hear the Sword. She stumbles, she runs, Lonnie calls her name. She has to get to the Sword.

Brambles and branches catch and rip at her fur, she never cared before. It's hard to breathe, something's tearing, it's getting harder. She shouldn't be moving, she's making it worse.

She doesn't care, she's dying. In a lot of ways it's a relief.

Glimmer felt like the weight of the whole world lifted off her shoulders when the doctor stepped out, grim determination on his face instead of resignation.

He confirmed what Glimmer was worried would happen. The Ghost is alive, but only just, without a blood transfusion- *to start with* - she wouldn't last the night. But they had *time.*

There's someone in her nest, two of them. It doesn't matter. All the bright blue glass- so precious, Her colours, Her eyes, **Adora,** *"Adora"*- sits piled high around the Sword that calls Adora's name. Catra stumbles, she's almost there. The ground hurts her knees, she tries to growl, but it comes out wrong, more a whisper, a wheeze.

She's almost there when it all goes dark. Maybe she'll see Adora again. She thinks she'd like that.

"Get her prepared to move," Glimmer decided, setting her feet as Bow stood firm at her side, "mom's just gonna have to deal."

End Notes

Come say hi at Makuta's Chronicle or genVicron!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!